

【8.26| The Guardian】 Will AI destroy film industry or **usher in**
a golden age? **人工智能会摧毁电影行业，还是会造就黄金时代？**

难度评级: ★★★☆☆

【考研那些事儿之商业系列】

今日文章脉络：

介绍一家 AI 影视工作室 Promise (Para. 1)



AI 模型日新月异，这些工作室可以
以较小的规模制作作品 (Para. 2)



此类工作室的增多引起部分影视工作者的不安 (Para. 3)



但也有部分业内人士看到这种技术的潜力，
真人演员可以实时与虚拟生成的背景互动 (Para. 4-5)



目前这类技术已经
大批量应用到市面上的作品中 (Para. 6)



AI 能够大幅削减电影制作成本 (Para. 7-8)



但它也面临不少质疑和抵制 (Para. 9-10)



AI 技术不断精进，
真人与 AI 混合或许是影视剧创作的趋势 (Para. 11)

【学习流程：第一遍请先看原文自己精读，第二遍对照着本精读文档进行理解。文章标注的单词为重点单词，只提供相关注释，想要详细释义麻烦同学查一下词典哦！另外文章底色为灰色的句子为今天的翻译作业，今日文档中的句子分析模块会提供答案，同学们请先思考再看句子分析～】

【Para. 1】

Near the **colonnaded** entrance to Sony Pictures' Culver City film studio, a tech-powered rival has **sprung up** this summer. The artists at Promise, a new studio **feeding off** the potential of AI, can see the **lots** where Singin' in the Rain and Men in Black were shot, but no longer do they need to get beyond the studio's high walls to make their visions come true.

- **usher** /'ʌʃə(r)/ **in v. (formal)** to be the beginning of sth new or to make sth new begin 开创；开始；开启

The change of management ushered in fresh ideas and policies. 更换领导班子带来了新思想和新政策。

- **colonnaded** a. /ˌkɒləˈneɪdɪd/ 有柱列的
- **feed off** n. (of an animal 动物) to eat sth 以...为食

Butterflies feed on the flowers of garden plants. 蝴蝶以园林中草木的花为食。

- **spring up** v. to appear or develop quickly and/or suddenly 迅速出现；突然兴起【考研大纲词汇】
- **lot** n. an area of land used for a particular purpose (作某种

用途的) 一块地, 场地【考研大纲词汇】

a parking lot 停车场

今年夏天, 在索尼影业卡尔弗城制片的柱廊入口附近, 一家科技驱动的竞争对手悄然崛起。Promise 是一家以借助人工智能 (AI) 创作的新锐工作室, 其艺术家们在工作室就可以望见索尼《雨中曲》和《黑衣人》的拍摄场地, 但如今他们已无需越过制片厂的高墙, 就能将自己的构想变为现实。

【Para. 2】

From far more modest premises, they are making movies with rapidly **accelerating** AI models that create backgrounds, special effects and even “**synthetic** performers” – using US models but also driven by market-leading Chinese AI. Backed by Google, Silicon Valley venture capitalists and Disney, Promise is one of a rising number of AI film studios in Hollywood.

- **accelerate** v. to happen or to make sth happen faster or earlier than expected (使) 加速, 加快【考研大纲词汇】
Inflation continues to accelerate. 通货膨胀不断加速。
- **synthetic** a. artificial; made by combining chemical substances rather than being produced naturally by plants or animals 人造的; (人工) 合成的【考研大纲词汇】

SYN man-made

synthetic drugs/fabrics 合成药物/织物

尽管与索尼相比，他们的办公场所要小得多，他们正利用飞速迭代的 AI 模型制作电影——这些模型能够生成背景、特效，甚至“合成演员”，它们既采用美国模型，也依托中国市场领先的 AI 技术。在谷歌、硅谷风险投资家和迪士尼的支持下，Promise 已成为好莱坞日益增多的 AI 电影工作室之一。

【Para. 3】

It is a **controversial** trend. Leading directors including Christopher Nolan and Guillermo del Toro have criticised generative technology, actors and writers are fearing for their jobs, and the Democrat congresswoman Laura Friedman, who represents Hollywood's actors, writers and directors, warned: "We can't wait until we see tens of thousands of American workers **displaced**."

- **controversial** a. /ˌkɒntreɪˈvɜːʃl/ causing a lot of angry public discussion and disagreement 引起争论的；有争议的【考研大纲词汇】

a highly controversial topic 颇有争议的话题

- **displaced** a. If a person or group of people is displaced, they are forced to move away from the area where they live.

使背井离乡【考研大纲词汇】

More than 600,000 people were displaced by the tsunami. 超过 60 万人被海啸搞得背井离乡。

这一趋势颇具争议。包括克里斯托弗·诺兰和吉尔莫·德尔·托罗在内的顶尖导演曾批评生成式技术，演员和编剧们也担心自己的饭碗不保。代表好莱坞演员、编剧和导演的民主党众议员劳拉·弗里德曼警告道：“我们不能等到看着数万名美国工人失业后，才采取行动。”

【Para. 4】

But the excitement and energy about AI was **palpable** this week at Promise's new base, when a human actor, Tori Thomas, waited for her call amid rows of computers on the studio's AI-**enabled** horror film, Touch Grass, with a budget in the low millions of dollars.

- **palpable** a. /'pælpəbəl/ You describe something as palpable when it is obvious or intense and easily noticed. 可感知的; 明显的

The tension between Amy and Jim is palpable. 埃米和吉姆之间的紧张关系是显而易见的。

- **enable** v. If someone or something enables you to do a particular thing, they give you the opportunity to do it. 使

能够【考研大纲词汇】

The new test should enable doctors to detect the disease early. 新的检验使医生能在早期发现该种疾病。

但本周在 Promise 的新基地，人们对人工智能的热情与活力显而易见。当时，真人演员托里·托马斯正置身于工作室中一排排电脑之间，等待拍摄指令，她正在参与一部由人工智能辅助制作的恐怖电影《Touch Grass》，该片的预算在数百万美元左右。

【Para. 5】

The sound stage was a corner of the office hung with white sheets. A small camera followed Thomas as she **scrambled** in a chase scene, then the AI **superimposed** her movement in real-time on to a field of swaying grass generated by a new Chinese AI model, Seedance 2.5, which looks as if it will **slash** production times. Whole scenes – actor and backdrop – were visible on the director’s **handheld** monitor as if they were filming in real locations. With a glance at the screen, Thomas could immediately see the backdrop she was acting with.

- **scramble v.** If you scramble over rocks or up a hill, you move quickly over them or up it using your hands to help you. 攀爬【考研大纲词汇】

Tourists were scrambling over the rocks looking for the perfect camera angle. 旅行者们爬上岩石，寻找最完美的拍摄角度。

- **superimpose v.** If one image is superimposed on another, it is put on top of it so that you can see the second image through it. 叠加

The image of a seemingly tiny dancer was superimposed on the image of the table. 一个看似很小的舞蹈者的影像被叠加在了那张桌子的影像上。

- **slash v.** [often passive] (often used in newspapers 常用于报章) to reduce sth by a large amount 大幅度削减；大大降低 to slash costs/prices/fares, etc. 大幅度降低成本、价格、车费等

- **handheld a.** A handheld device such as a camera or a computer is small and light enough to be used while you are holding it. 手持式的；掌上的

...a handheld electric mixer. ...一个手持式电动搅拌器

摄影棚就在公室的一个角落，四周挂着白色幕布。当托里·托马斯在追逐场景中四处奔跑时，一台小型摄像机跟拍着她，随后人工智能将她的动作实时叠加到由中国新型 AI 模型“Seedance 2.5”生成的随风摇曳的草地上——该模型有望将大幅缩短制作周期。整个场景——包括演员和背景——都清晰

地呈现在导演手持的监视器上，仿佛是在实景进行的拍摄。托马斯只需瞥一眼屏幕，就能立即看到自己正在与之互动的背景。

【Para. 6】

Promise is not alone in **embracing** the technology, which Netflix last week said it had used in 300 of its 1,000 titles in 2026. Imagine, the 41-year-old studio run by Brian Grazer and Ron Howard, the director of The Da Vinci Code and A Beautiful Mind, now has an AI studio, Obsidian, operating from space in its Beverly Hills HQ. Imagine has partnered with Obsidian to make The Code, an AI-enabled, Howard-directed **animated** feature based on drawings made in Vietnamese **captivity** by US prisoners of war.

- **embrace v.** If you embrace a change, political system, or idea, you accept it and start supporting it or believing in it. 欣然接受; 信奉【考研大纲词汇】

He embraces the new information age. 他欢迎新的信息时代。

- **animated a.** An animated film is one in which puppets or drawings appear to move. 动画的

Disney has returned to what it does best: making full-length animated feature films. 迪斯尼电影公司回到他们最拿手的事情：制作长篇动画故事片。

- **captivity** n. /kæp'tɪvəti/ [U] the state of being kept as a prisoner or in a confined space 监禁；关押；困住

He was held in captivity for three years. 他被监禁了三年。

Promise 并非唯一一家采用这项技术的公司。Netflix 上周表示，在 2026 年的 1000 部作品中，已有 300 部采用了该技术。由布莱恩·格雷泽和曾执导《达芬奇密码》《美丽心灵》的罗恩·霍华德共同运营的制片公司 Imagine，已有 41 年历史，如今也在其比佛利山庄总部内设立了名为“黑曜石”（Obsidian）的 AI 工作室。Imagine 已与黑曜石合作制作《密码》（The Code）——这是一部由霍华德执导、基于美国战俘在越南被俘期间所绘制的手稿改编的 AI 动画长片。

【Para. 7】

Brad Pitt this week said that, although there was a lot of resistance, “AI is going to be the very thing that, if used as a tool, is going to help these mid-budget films, \$40m to \$90m-budgeted films, get made.” That **chimed with** predictions from a new wave of AI native film-makers, such as Kavan “the Kid” Cardoza, 37, who has set up the Phantom X studio. He predicted a creative **renaissance circumventing** the studio giants not seen in more than 30 years.

- **chime (in) with sth** *phrase* (of plans, ideas, etc.) 计划、主意

等) to agree with sth; to be similar to sth 与...相一致 (或相似)

His opinions chimed in with the mood of the nation. 他的主张与国民的心态相吻合。

- **renaissance** n. a situation when there is new interest in a particular subject, form of art, etc. after a period when it was not very popular (某一学科或艺术形式等衰落后的) 复兴【考研大纲词汇】

SYN revival

to experience a renaissance 经历复兴

- **circumvent** v. /ˌsɜːkəm'vent/ (formal) to find a way of avoiding a difficulty or a rule 设法回避; 规避

They found a way of circumventing the law. 他们找到了规避法律的途径。

布拉德·皮特本周表示，尽管存在诸多阻力，“但如果将人工智能作为工具加以利用，它将大大助力这些中等预算的电影（即预算在 4000 万至 9000 万美元之间）完成制作。” 这一观点与新一代“原生 AI”电影制作人的预测不谋而合，例如 37 岁的卡万·“小鬼”·卡多扎 (Kavan “the Kid” Cardoza)，他创立了 Phantom X 工作室。他预测，一场绕过大型制片厂的创意复兴即将到来，而这是此前 30 多年来未曾见过的。

【Para. 8】

The Promise shoot involved **veteran** film-makers including Joel Hynek, an Oscar-winner who worked on the **manual** special effects for Arnold Schwarzenegger's 1987 action-horror film Predator. "When we went from optical to digital film, we thought we'd gone to heaven," he told the Guardian.

- **veteran** a. /'vetərən/ a person who has a lot of experience in a particular area or activity 经验丰富的人；老手【考研大纲词汇】

the veteran British actor, Sir Richard Attenborough 英国资深演员理查德·阿滕伯勒爵士

- **manual** a. /'mænjuəl/ (of work, etc.工作等) involving using the hands or physical strength 用手的；手工的；体力的【考研大纲词汇】

manual labour/jobs/skills 体力劳动/活儿；手工技巧

Promise 的拍摄团队汇聚了多位资深电影人，例如奥斯卡奖得主乔尔·海涅克——他曾参与阿诺德·施瓦辛格 1987 年动作恐怖片《铁血战士》的手工特效制作。“当我们从光学胶片转向数字电影时，我们仿佛置身天堂，”他告诉《卫报》。

【Para. 9】

Others, such as Nolan, voice concern. “I’ve never seen a technology advancing so rapidly, so completely rejected by the public,” the director of The Odyssey has said. “Everybody’s **suspicion** of it is so extreme, particularly young people.”

- **suspicion** n. /sə'spiʃn/ ~ (that...) a feeling that sb has done sth wrong, illegal or dishonest, even though you have no proof 怀疑；嫌疑【考研大纲词汇】

They drove away slowly to avoid arousing suspicion. 他们缓缓驾车离去，以免引起怀疑。

与此同时，诺兰等人则表达了担忧。这位《奥德赛》的导演曾表示：“我从未见过一项技术发展如此迅速，却又被公众如此排斥。大家对它的戒心非常强烈，尤其是年轻人。”

【Para. 10】

There has been **opposition** to an AI resurrection of the **late** actor Val Kilmer to star in a new feature and the **emergence** of the AI “actor” Tilly Norwood, with the actor Emily Blunt pleading: “Please stop taking away our human connection.”

- **opposition** n. /ˌɒpə'ziʃn/ [U] ~ (to sb/sth) the act of strongly disagreeing with sb/sth, especially with the aim of preventing sth from happening (强烈的) 反对，反抗，对抗

Delegates expressed strong opposition to the plans. 代表强烈反对这些计划。

- **late a.** [only before noun] (of a person 人) no longer alive 已故的【考研大纲词汇】

her late husband 她已故的丈夫

- **emergence n.** /ɪ'mɜːdʒəns/ The emergence of something is the process or event of its coming into existence. 兴起
...the emergence of new democracies in Latin America. ...拉丁美洲新民主国家的兴起。

针对利用人工智能“复活”已故演员瓦尔·基尔默出演新片，以及人工智能“演员”蒂莉·诺伍德的出现，外界出现了反对声浪。演员艾米丽·布朗特恳求道：“请别再剥夺我们的人际联结。”

【Para. 11】

But the new AI studios are **undeterred**. Dave Clark, director of Promise's Touch Grass said that with “great dialogue and **backstory**” AI-generated characters can become interesting and believable. The actors' union SAG-Aftra will no doubt **beg to differ**, but Cardoza predicted “next year [AI actors will] be just as good as real actors”. George Strompolos, co-founder and chief executive of Promise, estimated **hybrid** AI films – human actors **alongside** AI technology – will prove 20% to 50% cheaper

than conventional production. That could free film-makers from requiring major studio investment.

- **undeterred** a. /ˌʌndɪ'tɜːd/ if sb is undeterred by sth, they do not allow it to stop them from doing sth 顽强的；坚毅的；不屈不挠的
- **backstory** n. /'bækstɔːri/ the things that are supposed to have happened before the events in a film/movie, novel, etc. (电影、小说等的) 幕后故事，故事背景
- **beg to differ** *phrase* used to say politely that you do not agree with sth that has just been said 很抱歉，我不敢苟同【考研大纲词汇】
- **hybrid** a. of mixed character, composed of mixed parts 混合的；混合而成的
- **alongside** prep. together with or at the same time as sth/sb 与...一起；与...同时【考研大纲词汇】

Traditional beliefs still flourish alongside a modern urban lifestyle. 现代城市生活方式盛行的同时，传统信念仍然大行其道。

但新兴的 AI 制片公司并未因此却步。Promise 旗下《Touch Grass》的导演戴夫·克拉克表示，只要拥有“精彩的台词和背景故事”，AI 生成的角色就能变得生动有趣且令人信服。演员工会 SAG-AFTRA 无疑会持不同意见，但卡多扎预测：“明年，AI 演员的表现将与真人演员一样出色。” Promise 公

司的联合创始人兼首席执行官乔治·斯特罗姆波洛斯估计，混合型 AI 电影——即真人演员与 AI 技术并用的模式——制作成本将比传统制作低 20%至 50%。电影制作人或可以由此摆脱对大型制片厂投资的依赖。

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➤ 今日翻译作业

(Para. 5) A small camera followed Thomas as she scrambled in a chase scene, then the AI superimposed her movement in real time on to a field of swaying grass generated by a new Chinese AI model, Seedance 2.5, which looks as if it will slash production times.

（下一页提供句子分析）

➤ 今日句子分析

Para 5. A small camera followed Thomas as she scrambled in a chase scene, then the AI superimposed her movement in real time on to a field of swaying grass generated by a new Chinese AI model, Seedance 2.5, which looks as if it will slash production times. 当托里·托马斯在追逐场景中四处攀爬时，一台小型摄像机跟拍着她，随后人工智能将她的动作实时叠加到由中国新型 AI 模型 “Seedance 2.5” 生成的随风摇曳的草地上——该模型有望大幅缩短制作时间。

分句 1/主句

A small camera followed Thomas

主语 谓语 宾语

伴随状语从句

as she scrambled in a chase scene,

(引导词) 从句主语 谓语 地点状语

分句 2

then the AI superimposed her movement in real time

(连词) 主语 谓语 宾语 状语

on to a field of swaying grass

方向状语

generated by a new Chinese AI model, Seedance 2.5,

后置定语，修饰 a field of swaying grass model 的同位语

定语从句 表语从句

which looks as if it will slash production times.

从句主语 系语（引导词） 从句主语 谓语 宾语

句子分析：

分句 1/主句：

主语-A small camera；谓语-followed；宾语-Thomas；

伴随状语从句：

（引导词）-as；从句主语-she；谓语-scrambled（攀爬）；状语-in a chase scene（这个长分句可以断开翻译）；

分句 2：

（连词）-then；主语-the AI；谓语-superimposed；宾语-her movement；状语-in real time（“实时”）；状语-on to a field of swaying grass（on 提示位置；to 提示方向）；后置定语-generated by a new Chinese AI model；a new Chinese model 的同位语-Seedance 2.5；

定语从句，修饰 Seedance 2.5：

从句主语-which；系语-looks（looks as if...好像/似乎，这里则更偏向一种可能性）；

表语从句：

(引导词) -as if (好像；仿佛)；从句主语-it；谓语-will slash

(强调“大幅”减少)；宾语-production times.

➤ 写作积累

Para.1 but **no longer do** they need to get beyond the studio' s high walls to make their visions come true.

这是个典型的倒装句，no longer (“不再.....”) 为否定词，置于句首用来强调否定含义，因此引起句子的部分倒装。

正常语序为：

they no longer need....

部分倒装后，助动词 do 就得前移至主语前，其他常见否定词包括 never/rarely/not only...，例句：Never have I had such a good excuse for wallowing in deep warm baths. 我从不曾有过这样一个好理由，可以好好地享受个热水澡。（助动词 have 前移，否则就是 I have never had...）

其他常见引起部分倒装的情况还包括：

only+状语(从句)在句首时，同样主句部分助动词/情态动词或者 be 动词提前，例如：

only when (“只有在.....的时候”)： **Only when** each logical step has been checked by other mathematicians **will the proof be accepted** (情态动词 will 提前) . 只有在每个逻辑步骤都由其他数学家验证之后，该证明才会被接受。

only if (“只有在.....的条件下”)： **Only if** the red light comes on **is there** (被动词 is 提前) any danger to employees. 只

有红灯闪亮时才有危及职工的险情。

Para.11 The actors' union SAG Aftra will no doubt **beg to differ**, but Cardoza predicted "next year [AI actors will] be just as good as real actors" .

beg to differ 容易被误读为“求着要提出异议”，但实际上它只是一种谦逊表达，用 beg 来放低自己的姿态，可以理解为“恕难苟同”，beg to do sth 偶尔也可以表示“请允许……”。

英文中的常见委婉语还包括：

1. with all due respect “我很尊重你，但……” “恕我直言”
(后面一般跟反对意见)，例：With all due respect, the figures simply do not support you on this. 恕我直言，这些数字根本不能支持你的观点。
2. if I may, “如果我可以说……” (后跟请求)，例：I'd like the use of your living room, if I may. 如果可以，我想用用你的起居室。
3. I would highly appreciate it if... “您如果能……，我会十分感激”，例：I would appreciate it if you paid in cash. 假如你支付现金的话，我会不胜感激。